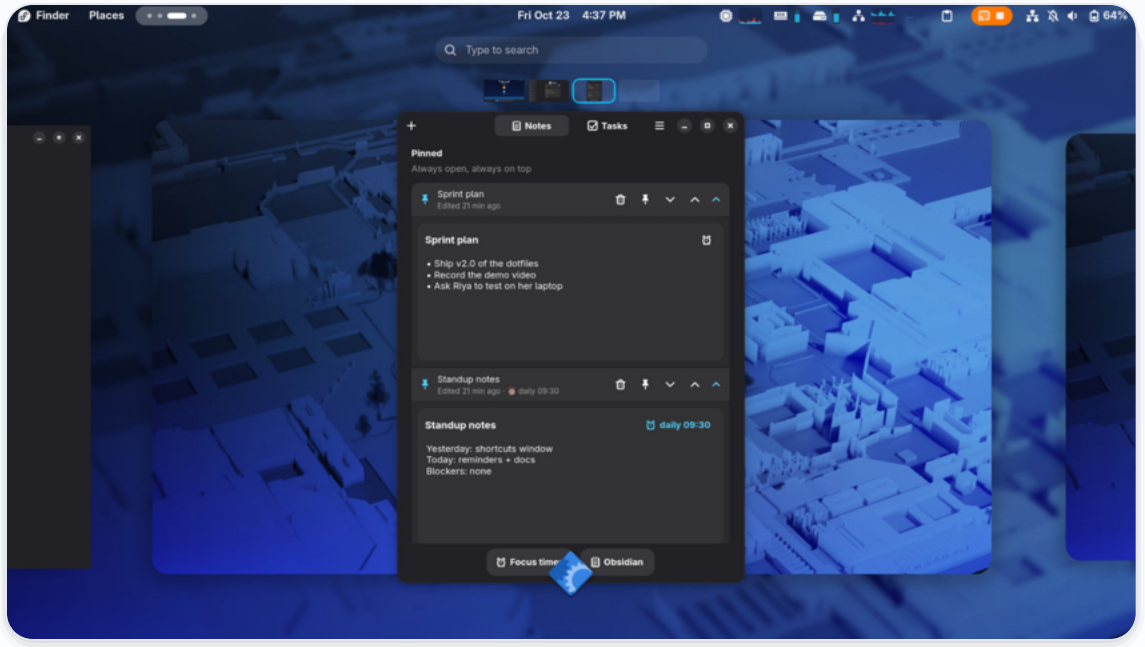
# MK Workstation

## Fedora, made for getting things done.

One command turns a fresh Fedora Workstation into a fast, familiar and productive desktop: Windows and macOS habits, notes and reminders, face unlock, and settings that adapt to your hardware.

**Fedora 44** **GNOME 50 · Wayland** **Open source**




The overview on an HP ENVY x360 13 running MK Workstation

THE STARTING POINT

# Stock Fedora Workstation

A clean, fast, secure Linux from the Fedora Project, backed by Red Hat. It ships the newest GNOME exactly as its designers intended, with very little added.

- **Strong foundation** SELinux, Wayland, Btrfs, automatic security updates, new release every 6 months.
- **Pure GNOME** One focused way of working: Activities overview, keyboard first, few settings.
- **Free software only** Patented codecs and hardware video decoding are left out by policy.

## What people notice in the first hour

- **No dock or tray icons** apps live in the overview only
- **No minimize button** and no Windows-style snapping or layouts
- **Alt+Tab per workspace** windows elsewhere are hidden
- **Videos use the CPU** H.264 / HEVC decoding isn't hardware-accelerated
- **Everything by hand** apps, extensions, shortcuts, codecs, drivers, one by one
- **No notes, tasks or reminders** beyond separate apps

WHAT IT ADDS

# Six things, one command

### One command
sudo ./setup.sh installs codecs, drivers, 60+ apps, extensions and settings. Safe to run again; backs up what it touches.

### Feels familiar
Dock, snap layouts, Alt+Tab across workspaces, macOS gestures and shortcuts, Windows keys like Super+E and Ctrl+Shift+Esc.

### Productivity built in
Notes, tasks and reminders, a focus timer, OCR, clipboard history and a live shortcuts window.

### Face and fingerprint
Log in by looking at the camera or touching the reader; both set up for the hardware you have.

### Smart for your device
Power profiles follow the charger, effects scale to the hardware, GPU video decoding is set up for your graphics.

### Yours to change
Every shortcut, app and name lives in plain text files. Rename it, rebind it, fork it.

SIDE BY SIDE

# Stock Fedora vs MK Workstation

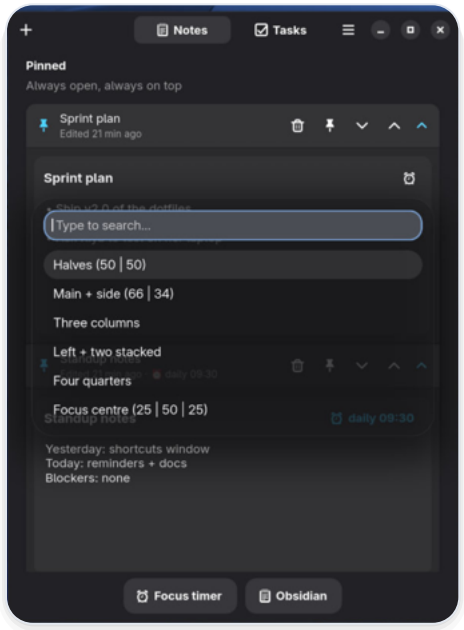
| | STOCK FEDORA | WITH MK WORKSTATION |
|---|---|---|
| **Setup** | Install apps, codecs and extensions by hand | One command, then mk update keeps it all current |
| **Video** | Software decoding for H.264 / HEVC | Full codecs + GPU decoding for your graphics card |
| **Windows** | Maximize and half-screen tiling | Snap layouts (Super+Z), quarters, always on top |
| **Switching** | Alt+Tab shows the current workspace | Alt+Tab shows everything, 3- and 4-finger gestures |
| **Dock** | Only inside the overview | Auto-hiding dock with app-coloured hover |
| **Notes & tasks** | Separate apps | Companion: pinned notes, tasks, reminders, morning brief |
| **Shortcuts** | Scattered across Settings | One window: status of each, change or reset in a click |
| **Battery** | Profile stays where you left it | Performance on AC, balanced on battery, saver when low |
| **Login** | Password | Face unlock and fingerprint, detected and set up for you |
| **Health** | — | mk doctor checks codecs, GPU, extensions, clashes, updates |
| **Sound** | Thin laptop speakers | B&O-style speaker tuning: EQ, bass, limiter (mk sound) |

DESKTOP AND MULTITASKING

# Windows habits, macOS feel, GNOME underneath




Alt+Tab: every window on every workspace, with live previews

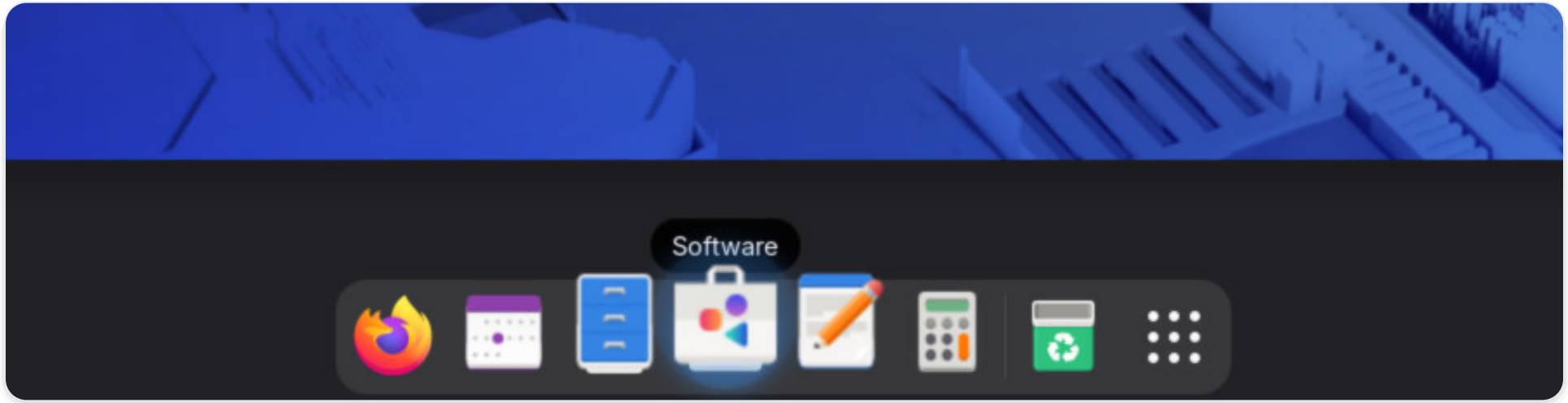



Super+Z: snap layouts

- **Gestures** 4 fingers ←/→ workspace, 3 fingers ←/→ window, 3 up overview
- **Snap** Super+arrows halves and quarters, Snap Assist
- **Spaces** Super+Ctrl+D new desktop, Super+Ctrl+←/→ move
- **Polish** genie minimize, soft open/close, 25% faster animations

THE DOCK

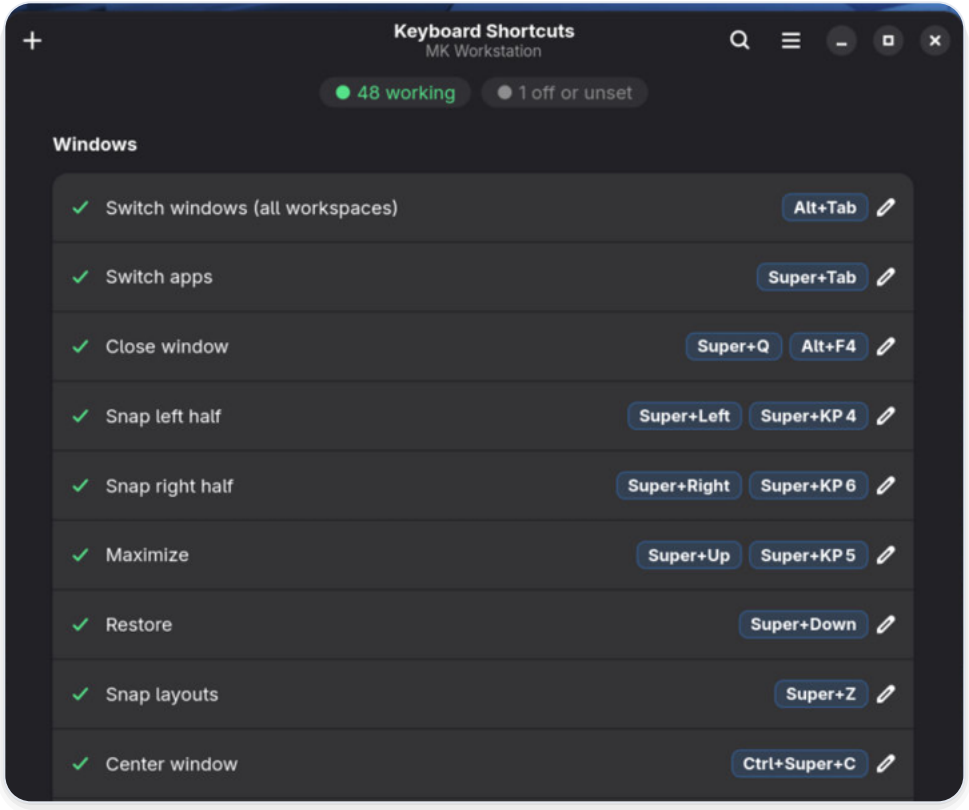
# A dock that feels alive, and stays out of the way




- **Magnification** the icon under the pointer grows and its neighbours follow in a soft wave, like macOS
- **App-coloured glow** a subtle circular tint in each app's own colour: Spotify green, Obsidian purple
- **Out of the way** hides when a window touches it and steps aside in the overview
- **Taskbar clicks** click to focus or minimize, thumbnails for apps with several windows, middle-click for a new one
- **Tunable** size, spread and speed in config/dock.conf; MAGNIFY=1 turns it off

SUPER + /

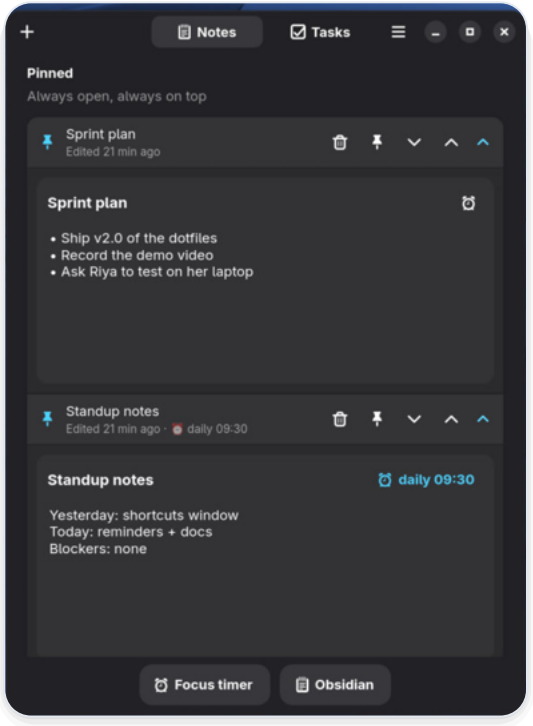
# Every shortcut, in one live window

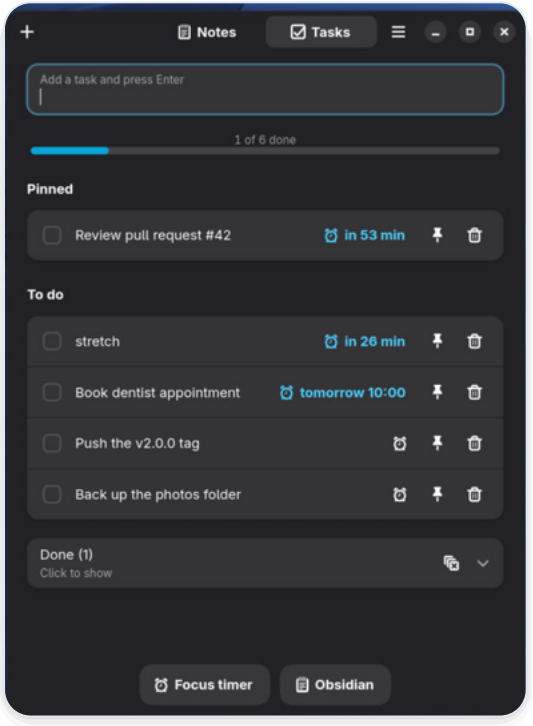



- **Live** reads GNOME directly; a change made anywhere shows up at once
- **Honest status** each shortcut marked working, clashing (and with what), unset or broken
- **Change in a click** press the new keys; add extra keys or remove them
- **Your own commands** + adds a shortcut that runs anything, e.g. a Spotify toggle
- **Undo** reset one shortcut or all of them to the defaults
- **Plain text underneath** config/shortcuts.conf: one line per shortcut, easy to fork

SUPER + SHIFT + N

# Companion: notes, tasks and reminders

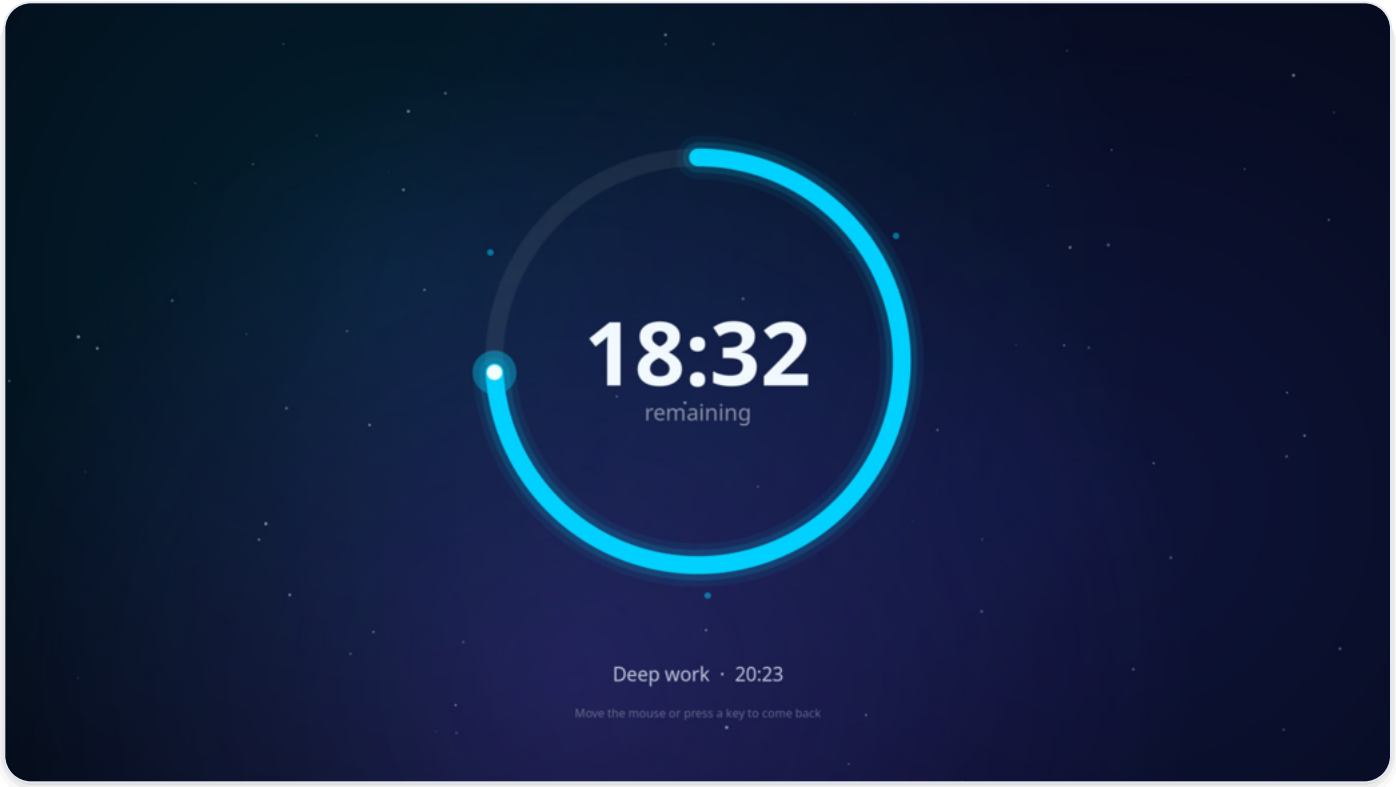


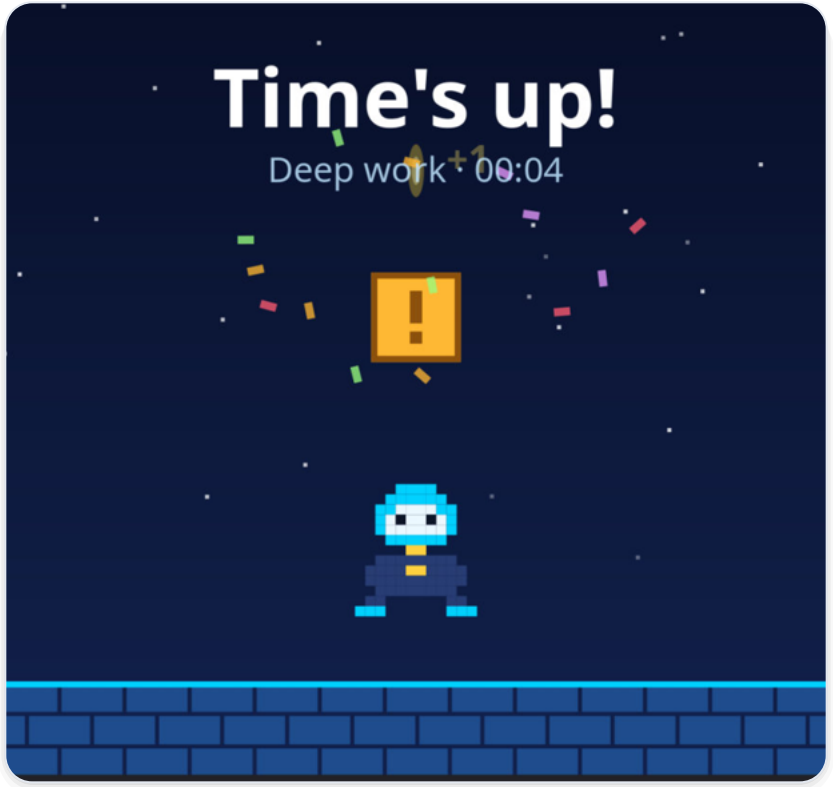

- **Notes that stay out of the way** pin the important ones open on top; the rest fold away
- **Tasks with a progress bar** tick, pin, undo; finished ones collect under Done
- **Reminders** in 10 min, at 18:00, every day or week; they fire even with the app closed, with Snooze
- **Morning brief** one notification with today's tasks and reminders
- **From the terminal** mk note, mk task "pay rent" 18:00, mk list

FOCUS TIMER

# Lives on your desktop, not in a window




Step away and the focus screen takes over, like a screensaver

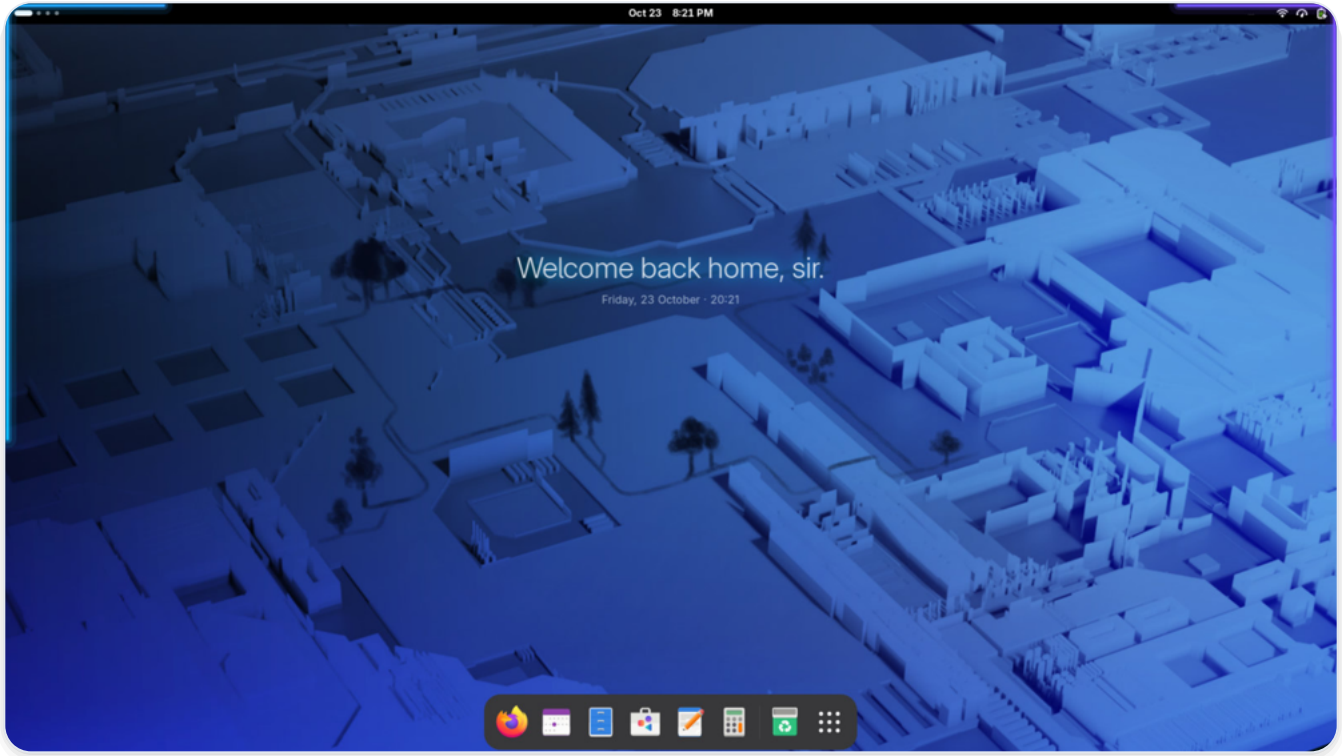



Time's up: robot, coins, fireworks

- **Out of the way** the window hides; a small ring and countdown sit in the top bar
- **Calm when you step away** aurora light and the big ring; any key brings you back; never covers a video
- **Focus mode** can silence notifications; a celebration instead of an alarm

AFTER YOU LOG IN

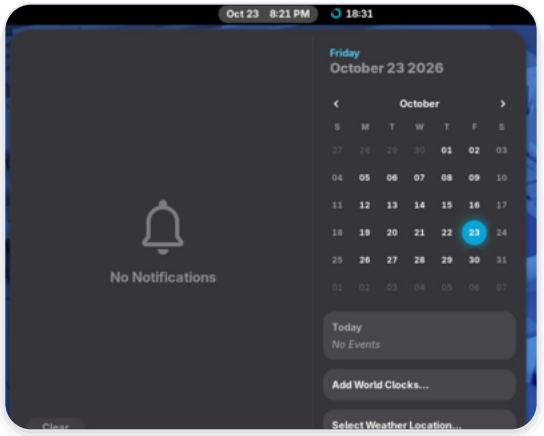
# Welcome back home, sir.



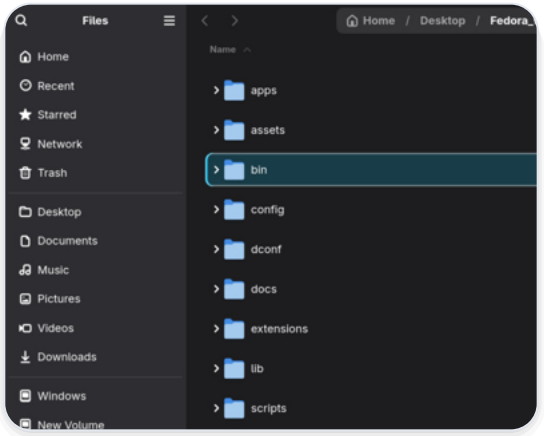

- **Neon edge light** a line races around the screen edges, OnePlus-style, then the greeting fades in
- **Waits for everything** plays once every extension has loaded, so login stays smooth
- **Sir, ma'am or your name** or write your own line; change it in Quick Settings or the Companion
- **A voice like an AI assistant** calm British voice (natural Piper voice optional, no sudo)
- **Your switch** Quick Settings › Welcome light, or mk welcome off

THE LITTLE THINGS

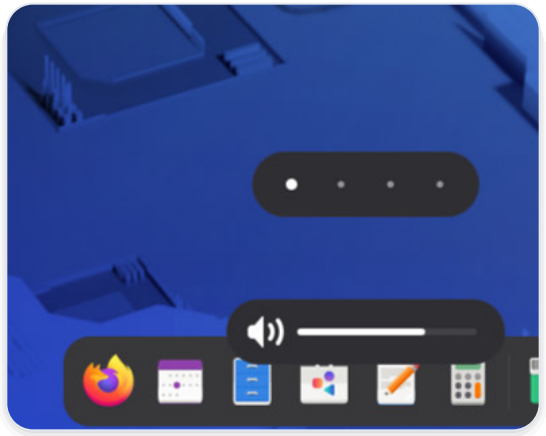
# Polished where you look every day



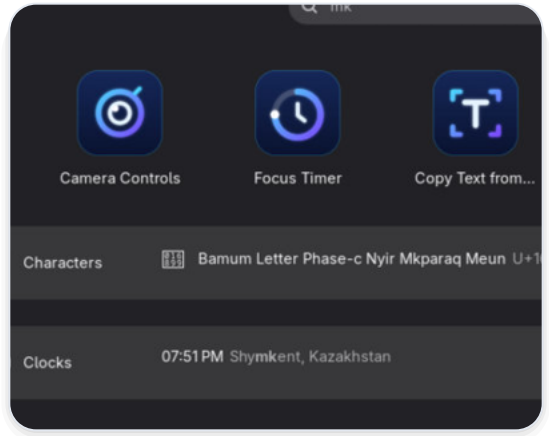

Calendar: glowing today, hover glow




Files: cyan hover and selection



Workspace dots step above volume

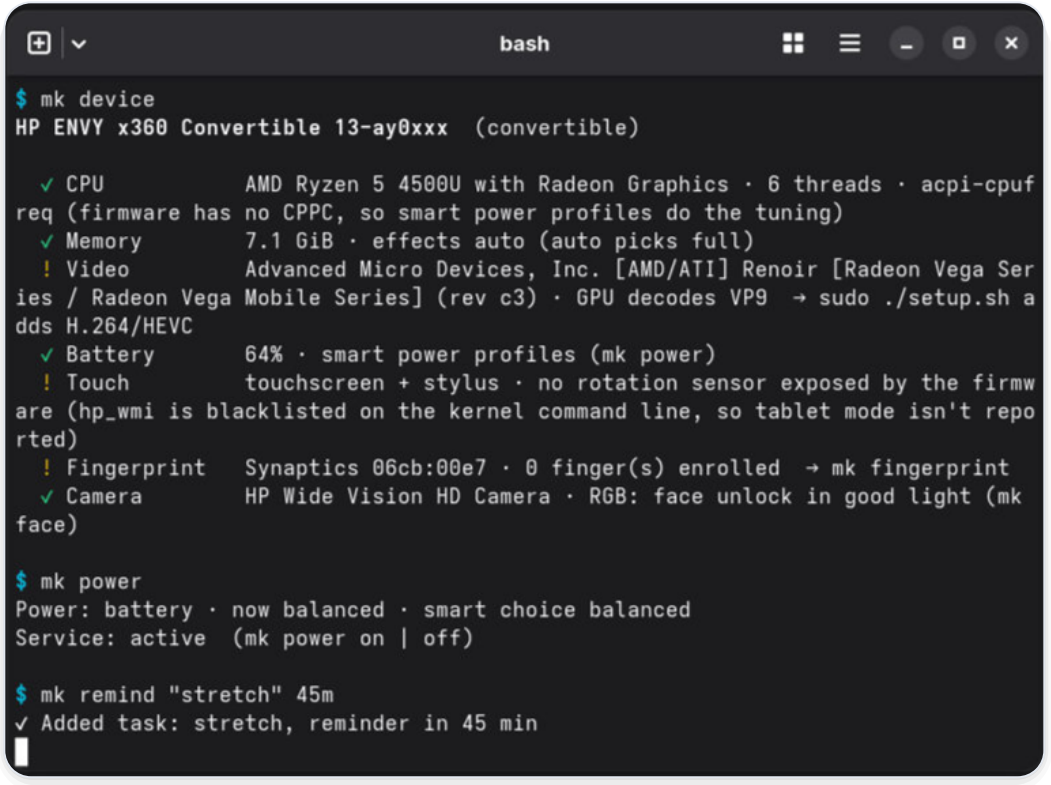


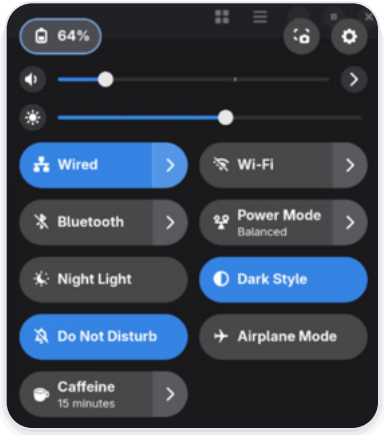

Own icons; swap in yours (mk icon)

- **Speaker tuning** laptop speakers sound thin on Linux without the vendor's Windows DSP; mk sound adds EQ, bass and a limiter
- **Alt+Tab** pops in smoothly; Alt+` switches windows of one app; wobbly windows while dragging
- **Dock** magnification and a soft glow in each app's colour

MADE FOR YOUR HARDWARE

# Detects the machine, then tunes for it




- **Fingerprint** reader detected, login and sudo enabled; mk fingerprint to enroll
- **Face unlock** IR or regular webcam, trained for normal, dim and bright light
- **Smart power** performance plugged in, balanced on battery, saver below 25%
- **Video** Intel, AMD or NVIDIA detected; GPU decoding for H.264 and HEVC
- **2-in-1s** rotation sensor service; effects scale to RAM and GPU
- **Smooth login** the login screen uses your display layout: no flicker

mk device on the author's HP ENVY x360 13 (Ryzen 5 4500U) · Quick Settings power mode

OPEN SOURCE

# Built to be changed

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **Rename it** | `mk rename "Riya's Desk" RD` | windows, notifications and the top-bar tag follow |
| **Rebind anything** | `config/shortcuts.conf` | or click a row in Super+/ |
| **Choose the apps** | `apps/flatpaks.txt` · `apps/dnf-packages.txt` | mk save captures what you installed |
| **Extensions** | `config/enabled-extensions.txt` | settings saved per extension by mk export |
| **Effects and power** | `config/effects.conf` · `config/power.conf` | plain key = value files |
| **Keep it current** | `mk update` | repo, apps, settings and system, in one go |

Documentation: GUIDE for everyday use, CUSTOMIZING for making it yours, ARCHITECTURE and REFERENCE for hacking on it.

GET STARTED

# Three commands on a fresh Fedora Workstation

1. `git clone https://github.com/MehulK-techie/fedora-workstation-config` — Download
2. `cd fedora-workstation-config && sudo ./setup.sh` — Install and configure (10–20 min)
3. `mk face  ·  mk fingerprint` — Optional: face and fingerprint login

Then log out and back in. Press **Super + /** to see every shortcut, **Super + Shift + N** for notes and tasks, and run **mk doctor** anytime.